Video script — MARCO Crystallisation Triage (target: 7:45, hard cap 8:00)

Shooting script for the coursework demo video. Each block has a target duration, what to have on screen, and narration to read/paraphrase in your own words — don't read it robotically, use it as talking points. Numbers below are pulled directly from `docs/report.md`, `experiments/log.csv` and `docs/genai_evaluation.md` — verified against those files, not invented for the video.

Before recording — have these open in tabs/windows ready to switch to, so there's no dead time hunting for files: 1. Terminal, repo root 2. `notebooks/01_eda.ipynb` (rendered, scrolled to the class/source distribution charts) 3. `notebooks/02_baseline.ipynb` (scrolled to the confusion matrix / PR curve) 4. `notebooks/03_ann_initial.ipynb` (learning curves) 5. `docs/report.md`'s Q3 comparison table (or the PDF, page showing it) 6. Browser at `http://127.0.0.1:8000` (confirm the backend is running — see below) 7. `notebooks/04_xai.ipynb` (Grad-CAM/occlusion/LIME comparison figure) 8. `docs/genai_evaluation.md`'s comparison table 9. The false-negative test image ready to upload: `data/raw/Crystals/X00000459107432005021123 53.png`

Start the backend before recording:

```
PYTHONPATH=src uvicorn app.backend.main:app --host 127.0.0.1 --port 8000
```

0:00–0:20 — Intro (0:20)

Show: face-cam or title slide with project name.

> *This is my MSc coursework project: triaging protein crystallisation drop images into Clear, Crystals, Precipitate, or Other, using the MARCO dataset. The goal is to help a crystallographer prioritise which drops to inspect for crystals worth harvesting — so missing a real crystal is far more costly than a false alarm, and that asymmetry drives every modelling decision I made.*

0:20–0:45 — Data download (0:25)

Show: terminal — `scripts/download_extract.py` and `data/splits.csv` head.

> *The data comes from MARCO — about 14,400 images across 15 shards, downloaded and extracted from the original TFRecord format. I split it once into train/validation/test — 71/14/14% — fixed in `data/splits.csv` for the whole project; the test set is only touched once, at the end, by `final_eval.py`.*

> *One thing I handled carefully: images of the same physical drop had to stay on one side of the split, or a model could see a near-duplicate of a test image during training. I recovered plate/well identity from filename conventions, and actually found and fixed a real leak this way — 44% of images moved splits once I added a pattern I'd missed.*

0:45–1:30 — EDA (0:45)

Show: `01_eda.ipynb` — class distribution bar chart, then source-distribution chart.

> *Three things from the EDA shaped everything downstream. First, Crystals is a real minority class — about 12% of the data — and the cost of missing one is much higher than a false alarm, which is why I never use plain accuracy as the headline metric. Instead my primary metric is **recall on Crystals at a fixed minimum precision of 0.30** — set from the baseline's own validation precision-recall curve, so the threshold isn't arbitrary.*

> *Second, class mix varies sharply by source institution — one source is 62% of all the data but only has 4.9% Crystals, while a tiny source has 45% Crystals — a nine-times swing. That's a real risk of the model implicitly overfitting to the dominant institution's imaging style, and it shows up later in my error analysis.*

> *Third, image sizes aren't standardised — anywhere from 632×504 up to 2448×2048 — so preprocessing needed an explicit, documented resize strategy rather than assuming a fixed input size.*

1:30–2:10 — Classical baseline: LightGBM (0:40)

Show: `02_baseline.ipynb` — confusion matrix and PR curve; optionally the feature-importance chart from `docs/figures/q3_baseline_feature_importance.png`.

> *Before any neural network, I built a classical baseline — LightGBM on hand-crafted HOG and LBP features. I chose LightGBM over XGBoost and SVM after comparing training speed and multiclass support — it trains fast enough on ten thousand images that I could give it a hyperparameter search budget of the same order of magnitude as the ANN, which matters for a fair comparison. HOG captures edge and gradient structure — crystal facets have sharp, consistent edges — and LBP captures local texture, which is what actually separates Precipitate's grainy look from Clear's smoothness. Together they're genuinely complementary: in the trained model, the top 20 most important features split exactly 10/10 between the two.*

> *On the test set, this baseline alone reaches 0.937 recall at my precision floor — a strong, fast result the ANN then has to actually beat, not just match.*

2:10–3:15 — Initial ANN: 3 hyperparameters, and why RunPod not Colab (1:05)

Show: `03_ann_initial.ipynb` learning curves; terminal showing `train_ann.py --help` or the hyperparameter search bar chart.

> *For the ANN I used a pretrained ResNet backbone — ImageNet weights — with the backbone frozen and a new Dropout-plus-Linear head trained on top. I searched three required hyperparameters: learning rate, batch size, and network depth — ResNet18 versus ResNet34 — twelve configs, randomly sampled from a 24-point grid, each trained for 12 epochs.*

> *Training this on a laptop CPU wasn't realistic, so I needed a GPU. I started on Google Colab's free tier, but ran into GPU quota limits partway through a twelve-config search — it would cut me off mid-run. I looked at upgrading to a paid Colab subscription, but worked out that for the actual amount of GPU time I needed — a few hours total — renting a GPU pod on RunPod by the hour was both cheaper and more predictable than paying for a subscription, so I moved the training there instead. The code itself didn't change — `train_ann.py` runs the same either way, it's purely an infrastructure choice.*

> *The learning curves showed train and validation loss both drop in epoch one and then plateau, with no divergence between them — so no overfitting, but also no further improvement: with the backbone frozen, only about two thousand head parameters are actually learning, which isn't enough capacity to keep extracting more signal. That plateau is exactly what motivated the next step.*

> *I also hit one real failed experiment here, logged as-is rather than hidden: a high learning rate with a small batch size made training diverge — loss rose instead of falling, recall collapsed to 0.62.*

3:15–4:25 — Final ANN: 4th hyperparameter, comparison table, error analysis (1:10)

Show: `docs/report.md` Q3 comparison table (or the PDF page).

> *With the lecturer's approval, I added a fourth hyperparameter: degree of fine-tuning — frozen versus unfreezing the backbone's last block, `layer4`, alongside the head. That gives the model real capacity to adapt its highest-level features to crystallisation images specifically, not just reuse ImageNet features as-is.*

> *Here's the full comparison on the held-out test set, each model run exactly once through* `final_eval.py`*:*
>
> - *Trivial majority-class benchmark: 0.0 recall at the precision floor — obviously unusable, it exists to show accuracy alone is a bad metric: 48% accuracy, zero crystals ever caught.*
> - *Classical baseline: 0.937.*
> - *Initial ANN, frozen: 0.886 — and interestingly, this one actually loses to the baseline on test despite beating it clearly on validation. I report that honestly rather than smoothing it over — it's a genuine validation/test reversal.*
> - *Final ANN, layer4 unfrozen:* ***0.965*** *— the best result, and the gap held up on test, which is good evidence the unfreeze produced a real improvement rather than overfitting to validation through repeated model selection.*

> *So my pre-registered expectation — that the ANN would win — was correct, but only once I actually unfroze part of the backbone; the frozen version alone wasn't enough.*

> *I also did a proper error analysis on the Final ANN's test errors, not just the aggregate number. Breaking accuracy down by source institution shows real spread — 60% on the two smallest, most underrepresented sources, up to 85% on the largest — directly confirming the EDA's source-imbalance finding on held-out data, not just a hypothesis. And Precipitate is the single biggest source of confusion for every other class, on both the baseline and the ANN — so that's a dataset-level pattern, not something specific to one architecture.*

4:25–6:05 — Live demo: web app, real-time prediction, Grad-CAM (1:40)

Show: browser at `http://127.0.0.1:8000`. Upload a normal, correctly-classified test image first (e.g. a clear Crystals example).

> *This is the web app — FastAPI backend, simple frontend. Every prediction here runs the actual trained model fresh, right now, nothing is precomputed. I'll upload a crystal image.*

[Upload image, let it run, point at the result]

> *It returns a score for all four classes and the predicted class — and I'm careful about how this is worded: this is the model's raw softmax output, not a calibrated, guaranteed confidence. It reflects patterns learned from training data, not proof of correctness.*

[Point at the Grad-CAM overlay]

> *And this is the explanation feature — Grad-CAM, highlighting the region the model's gradients were most sensitive to for this prediction. I picked Grad-CAM as the primary method because it's fast enough to run live in the app, unlike LIME or occlusion, which I only use for offline comparison. It's presented to a crystallographer as "where to look," not a verdict — it doesn't prove the model's true reasoning, just gives supporting evidence.*

> *I didn't just trust that blindly — I ran two required sanity checks on it. First, occluding the Grad-CAM region on a misclassified image dropped its Crystals probability from 0.624 down to 0.136, confirming the highlighted area is actually driving the prediction, not just correlated with it. Second, re-randomising the trained layers' weights changed the heatmap completely — correlation of minus 0.33 with the original — which confirms the explanation genuinely depends on what the model learned, not just the network's architecture.*

6:05–6:50 — A real incorrect prediction (0:45) — required

Show: upload `data/raw/Crystals/X00000459107432005021123 53.png` — a true Crystals image the Final ANN confidently misclassifies.

> *Now let me show a real failure — this is actually required in my brief, and it's important: no model is perfect, and showing one honestly matters more than pretending it doesn't happen. This image is a true Crystals drop, but the model predicts it with only 0.8% Crystals probability — a confident false negative, which is exactly the costly error type for this project, since a missed crystal could mean losing a hit from scarce protein.*

[Point at Grad-CAM overlay on this image]

> *Looking at the Grad-CAM for this one — in my offline comparison, Grad-CAM, occlusion and LIME all agree and point at the same central region of the drop. So the model isn't looking in a nonsensical place — it's looking at the right area and still getting the label wrong. That tells me this is an error of interpretation, not attention — worth knowing, because it means more data from this kind of drop would help more than architecture changes would.*

6:50–7:30 — GenAI comparison (0:40)

Show: `docs/genai_evaluation.md` comparison table.

> *Finally, I compared all of this against a pretrained vision-language model — Claude Haiku 4.5 — zero-shot, no training on MARCO at all, evaluated on the exact same test images with the same metric. It did **worse than every trained model, and worse than the trivial majority-class benchmark** — 0.0 recall at the precision floor,*

> *26% accuracy. It tends to over-use "Other" as a catch-all and confuses Precipitate with Crystals constantly. I'm reporting that as-is, not softened — it's the honest result.*

> *What it does offer that the trained models don't: zero labelled training data needed, and no training cost — but a real per-prediction cost forever, about 66 cents per thousand images, versus near-zero marginal cost once a trained model exists. And every image sent to it leaves the building, over the network, to a third party — a real privacy consideration a facility would have to weigh. A realistic use for it isn't replacing the classifier — it's sitting downstream, turning a Grad-CAM-flagged result into a plain-language description for a crystallographer glancing at the output.*

7:30–7:50 — Wrap-up (0:20)

Show: face-cam or the comparison table again.

> *So: a fixed, leakage-checked split, a classical baseline that's genuinely hard to beat, an ANN that only wins once part of the backbone is unfrozen, a sanity-checked Grad-CAM explanation, and a GenAI baseline that shows why domain-specific training still matters. Everything shown today ran live, nothing precomputed. Thanks for watching.*

Timing budget check

Section	Duration	Running total
Intro	0:20	0:20
Data download	0:25	0:45
EDA	0:45	1:30
Classical baseline	0:40	2:10
Initial ANN + RunPod	1:05	3:15
Final ANN + comparison + error analysis	1:10	4:25
Live demo (prediction + Grad-CAM + sanity checks)	1:40	6:05
Incorrect prediction (required)	0:45	6:50
GenAI comparison	0:40	7:30
Wrap-up	0:20	7:50

Leaves ~10s buffer under the 8:00 cap. This now explicitly covers all four checklist items: error analysis (Final ANN section), request-time prediction (live demo), a sanity-checked XAI method (both required sanity checks named with their actual numbers), and an incorrect

prediction analysed with XAI (required: 1 in video, 3 in the report's Q5). If you run long in practice, trim "Data download" or "Wrap-up" first — not the live demo, the incorrect prediction, or the sanity-check lines, since those are what the checklist is actually looking for.